Build, run and margin estimate · 28 October 2026

What AutoJopps costs to build, run and earn

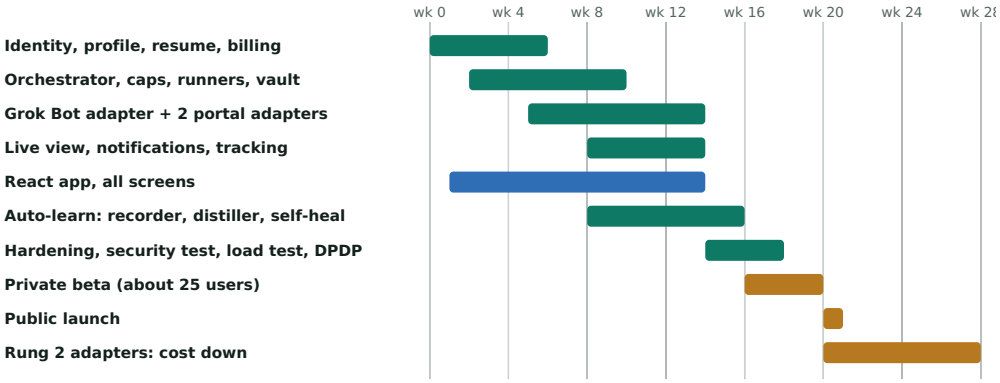
Time and cost to build, AWS bill, server sizing, users per server, and margin at ₹501, ₹1,001 and ₹2,001.

The answers in five lines

1. **Build:** about 4.5 months and ₹50-60 lakh for a 5-person team (including auto-learn) to public launch; about ₹10-12 lakh and 2 more months to cut cost per application. A solo founder with AI help: 8-10 months and ₹5-9 lakh cash.
2. **Cloud:** about $0.9k (₹0.8 L) a month at 100 users, $2.0k (₹1.9 L) at 500, $6.3k (₹6.0 L) at 2,000, once automation is scripted (rung 2).
3. **Server:** a runner is a 4 vCPU, 8 GB Linux machine (c6i.xlarge); the control plane is 2 small app nodes, one Postgres and one Redis.
4. **Users per server:** about 180 on a scripted Linux runner; about 60 on a Windows GUI machine.
5. **Margin:** 63-66% per user on scripted automation, 79-82% if mostly scripted. Per user it can be negative on the GUI bot. Cloud costs alone break even near 140 users; a paid team needs about 1,100-1,400.

How to read this. Only the c6i.xlarge price ($0.17 an hour in Mumbai) and the Claude API rates (Haiku 5.5 $0.10 in / $0.50 out, Sonnet 5.5 $2 / $10 per million tokens) were checked. Everything else is my estimate with the assumptions listed in section 7. Replace them with measured numbers from a 25-user pilot.

1. Cost and time to build



Team plan, 5 people. Green: build work. Blue: front end in parallel. Amber: launch and cost-down.

Module	Person-weeks
Identity, profile, resume parsing, onboarding form	6
Preferences, target JDs, matching	4
Billing and entitlements (Razorpay)	4
Orchestrator, state machine, caps	6
Runner fleet, Grok Bot adapter, 2 portal adapters	10
Live-view gateway	4
Session vault and security	3
Notifications (WhatsApp, email)	3
Tracking and inbox signals	4
React app, all screens	8
Infra, CI, observability	4
QA, load and hardening	5
Auto-learn: skill recorder, distiller, answer memory, self-heal (new)	10
Legal, DPDP, Google verification (non-engineering)	3
Total	**about 74**

Option	People	Time to public launch	Cash cost	Note
A. Small team	2 backend, 1 front end, 1 automation, 0.5 DevOps, 0.5 QA, 0.5 design	about 18 weeks (4.5 months)	₹50-60 L	+ about 8 weeks and ₹10-12 L for rung 2 adapters

B. Lean	2 engineers + Claude Code	about 32 weeks	₹21-26 L	Slower; same scope
C. Solo founder + AI	You, part time	34-40 weeks	₹5-9 L	Mostly your time; hire for security review

Cash costs assume fully loaded monthly rates (backend ₹2.5 L, front end ₹1.8 L, automation ₹2.2 L, DevOps ₹2 L, QA ₹1.2 L, design ₹1.5 L) plus ₹5-8 L for legal and DPDP advice, penetration test, tools and build-time cloud. Google restricted-scope verification and its security assessment add elapsed time and a fee I could not price; get a quote before committing.

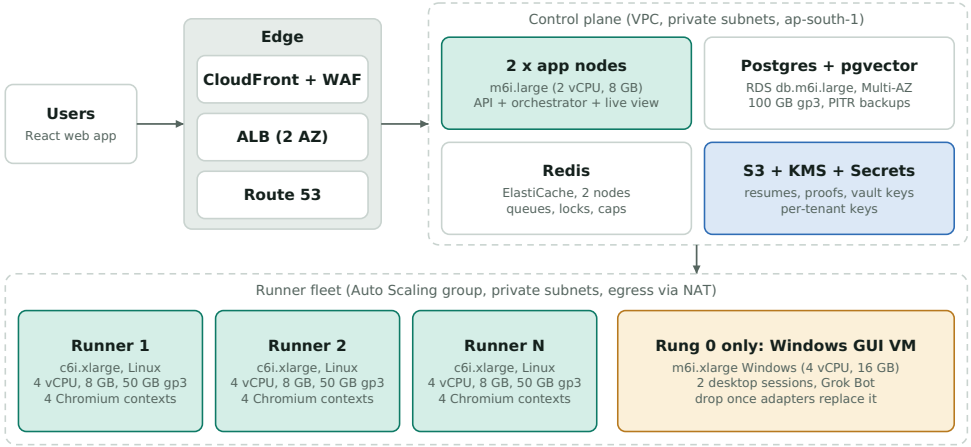
2. Cloud cost to operate (AWS Mumbai)

Scale	Runners	Runners $	Platform $	Claude API $	WhatsApp $	Total / month	In rupees
100 users	2	$248	$450	$161	$5	**$864**	**₹82,259**
500 users	4	$496	$700	$807	$26	**$2,030**	**₹1.93 L**
2,000 users	13	$1,613	$1,400	$3,230	$105	**$6,348**	**₹6.04 L**

This is rung 2 (scripted Linux runners, Haiku 5.5 for most steps and Sonnet 5.5 for tailoring, about ₹1.2 per application for the model) at on-demand prices. Reserved or committed pricing lowers the compute part; I have not priced it. Rung 3 cuts the model part roughly in half.

> **Rung 1 is the cost trap.** If Claude drives the Grok Bot screen by screenshots through the API, each application can need hundreds of thousands of input tokens. My estimate is ₹6 per application all-in, above the ₹4.16 net revenue per application, so cost per application is higher than revenue. Measure this first.

3. Server configuration



Production shape: two availability zones for the control plane; the runner fleet scales with demand.

Part	Spec	Count to start	Why
App node	m6i.large, 2 vCPU, 8 GB	2	API, orchestrator and live view are light; 2 for availability
Database	RDS Postgres db.m6i.large, Multi-AZ, 100 GB gp3, pgvector	1	At 2,000 users, about 256,000 applications a month is only about 6 a minute
Cache and queue	ElastiCache Redis, 2 nodes	1	Caps, locks, job queues
Runner (rung 2)	c6i.xlarge, Linux, 4 vCPU, 8 GB, 50 GB gp3	2 to start, +1 spare	About 4 Chromium contexts at once, each 1 vCPU and 2 GB
Runner (rung 0)	m6i.xlarge Windows, 4 vCPU, 16 GB	as needed	GUI bot; 2 desktop sessions; Windows licence adds cost (not priced here)
Storage and keys	S3, KMS, Secrets Manager	-	Resumes, proofs, per-tenant vault keys
Edge	CloudFront, WAF, ALB, NAT	-	TLS, bot and abuse protection, controlled egress

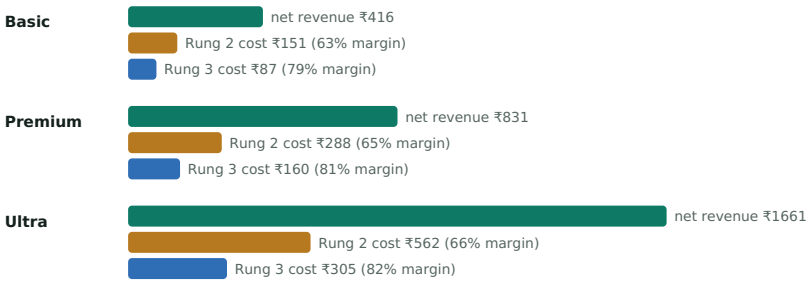
4. How many users per server

Server	Applications a month	Users	How I got it

Linux runner, scripted (rung 2)	about 24,000	**about 180** (120-250)	4 browsers x 43,200 minutes x 40% busy / 2.5 minutes per application, less 15% for waiting on humans
Linux runner, mostly scripted (rung 3)	about 38,000	**about 300**	Same, 1.5 minutes per application
Windows GUI machine (rung 0)	about 8,600	**about 60**	2 desktops, 4 minutes per application
Control plane (all of it)	-	**2,000 to 5,000**	Not the bottleneck; browsers are

An average user makes about 128 applications a month (60% Basic, 30% Premium, 10% Ultra, each using 80% of the cap). The daily caps spread the work across the day, so peaks stay modest.

5. Profit margin at ₹501, ₹1,001, ₹2,001



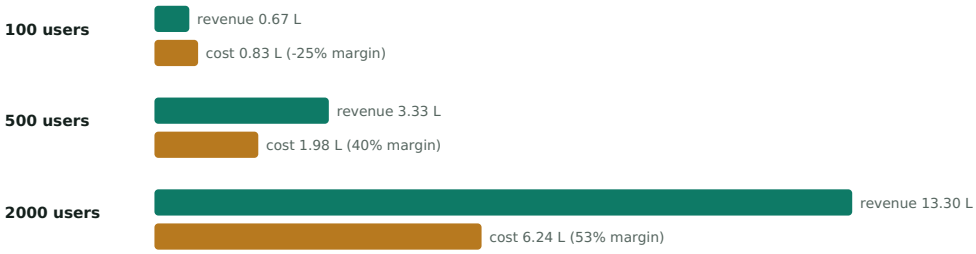
Per user per month, scripted automation. Cost includes the runner share, model, messaging (₹5) and support (₹10). Net revenue removes 18% GST and a 2% gateway fee.

Contribution margin, per user, after cloud, model, messaging and support, before salaries and marketing:

Tier	Net revenue	Rung 1 (GUI)	Rung 2 (scripted)	Rung 3 (mostly scripted)
Basic ₹501	₹416	loss (about -80%)	about 63%	about 79%
Premium ₹1,001	₹831	loss (about -78%)	about 65%	about 81%
Ultra ₹2,001	₹1,662	loss (about -77%)	about 66%	about 82%

The three tiers have almost the same margin because price scales with the cap. Rung 1 uses my ₹6 an application assumption. The honest ceiling is: the all-in cost of one application must stay under about ₹5 (Basic, 80% used) or ₹4.16 (any tier at full cap).

Company view, rung 2



Revenue and operating cost in ₹ lakh a month (cloud, model, messaging, support). Excludes team, marketing and customer acquisition.

Users	Revenue	Cost	Margin	Margin, rung 3
100	₹66,524	₹83,259	-25%	-14%
500	₹3.33 L	₹1.98 L	40%	56%
2,000	₹13.30 L	₹6.24 L	53%	69%

- **Cloud break-even:** about 130-150 users (rung 2).
- **Running team:** a team costing about ₹5 L a month needs roughly 1,400 users on rung 2 or 1,100 on rung 3.
- **Not included:** cost to acquire a user, churn, refunds, free trial usage and portal blocks.

6. What to do about it

1. Run a 25-user pilot and measure real cost per application on the GUI bot. This one number decides the plan.
2. Move model calls to the API and use Haiku 5.5 for most steps.
3. Ship rung 2 adapters for your top 2 portals before spending on marketing.

4. Reserve instances only after 3 months of stable load.

7. Assumptions

- Rupee at ₹95.1 per dollar; 18% GST included in price; 2% gateway fee.
- Mix 60/30/10; every tier uses 80% of its monthly cap.
- Per application: rung 1 ₹6, rung 2 ₹1.2, rung 3 ₹0.6 (model and orchestration, my estimates).
- Windows machine about $0.35 an hour (estimate; licence not verified).
- Platform (database, cache, load balancer, NAT, logs): $450, $700, $1,400 a month at 100, 500, 2,000 users (estimate).
- WhatsApp and email ₹5, support ₹10 per user a month (estimates).

Sources

- EC2 c6i.xlarge, ap-south-1 price
- Claude Haiku 5.5 and Sonnet 5.5 API prices

Checked 28 October 2026. Estimates, not quotes.